

Missing Addends Within 20

Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. 4	3. 6	5. 7	7. 8
2. 5	4. 9	6. 8	8. 8, 5, —

Common wrong answers

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6. *If they got 32: added the two numbers in the story instead of finding the missing part*
 7. *If they got 18: added 5 and 13 instead of taking the known part away from the whole*
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1. Ten-frame: $6 + \underline{\quad} = 10$. The mat already shows 6 counters and the full mat is 10. Count on from 6 until you reach 10: 7, 8, 9, 10 — that is 4 counts. Check by subtracting the known part from the whole: $10 - 6 = 4$, and $6 + 4 = 10$. The missing addend is 4.

2. Two ten-frames: $8 + \underline{\quad} = 13$. Eight counters are shown and Ana wants 13. Count on from 8: 9, 10, 11, 12, 13 — that is 5 counts, so the student draws 5 more counters. Check: $13 - 8 = 5$, and $8 + 5 = 13$. The missing addend is 5.

3. Number bond: whole 15, known part 9. The two parts must join to make the whole, so the missing part is what is left of the whole after the known part is taken away: $15 - 9 = 6$. Count-on check: from 9 say 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15 — that is 6 counts, and $9 + 6 = 15$. The missing part is 6 apples.

4. Crayons: $7 + \underline{\quad} = 16$. The full box is the whole, the crayons already inside are the known part, so the subtraction sentence that finds the missing part is $16 - 7 = \underline{\quad}$. Solve it by taking 7 from 16: from 16 count back 7 (15, 14, 13, 12, 11, 10, 9), landing on 9. Check: $7 + 9 = 16$. The missing addend is 9.

5. Cube train: $\underline{\quad} + 5 = 12$. The whole train is 12 cubes and the gray end part is 5 cubes, so the white part is the whole minus the gray part: $12 - 5 = 7$. Check: $7 + 5 = 12$, which matches the picture. The white part is 7 cubes long.

6. Tower: the whole tower is 20 cubes and 12 cubes are already stacked. The blue cubes are the missing part, so the equation is $12 + \underline{\quad} = 20$, which is found by $20 - 12$. Take 12 from 20: 20 make ten first, $20 - 10 = 10$, then $10 - 2 = 8$. Check: $12 + 8 = 20$. Sam still needs 8 cubes.

7. Find the mistake: $5 + \underline{\quad} = 13$. Mia *added* the part she has and the whole she wants ($5 + 13 = 18$). That is the error: 13 is not a second part, it is the total, so it must be broken apart, not added on. The correct move is to take the known part away from the whole: $13 - 5 = 8$. Check: $5 + 8 = 13$. The missing number is 8, not 18.

8. Two missing numbers. First equation: $\underline{\quad} + 6 = 14$. Take the known part from the whole, $14 - 6 = 8$, and check $8 + 6 = 14$. The first missing number is $\boxed{8}$.
Second equation: $9 + \underline{\quad} = 14$. Again take the known part from the whole, $14 - 9 = 5$, and check $9 + 5 = 14$. The second missing number is $\boxed{5}$.
Compare the two missing numbers: 8 is greater than 5, so the correct symbol is $\boxed{>}$.
Notice *why*: both equations have the same whole, so the bigger known part leaves the smaller missing part.